

HC Services — People Code

Section 6: Disciplinary Policy

Section 6.0: Document Control

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2.0	1 January 2025	—	Current version.

Section 6.1: Policy Scope

This policy governs conduct. Shortfalls in **capability** — where an employee is trying but unable to meet the requirements of the role — are dealt with under HC-PC-008, not here. Confusing the two is the most common procedural error; a capability matter run as a disciplinary is liable to be overturned on grievance under HC-PC-009 §9.2.

Section 6.2: Suspension

An employee may be suspended on full pay pending investigation. Suspension is a neutral act and is not a disciplinary sanction. Annual leave does not accrue during suspension (HC-PC-001 §1.3.2).

Section 6.3: Unauthorised Absence

Absence without approved leave or emergency notification, as defined at HC-PC-001 §1.8, is treated as unpaid and is managed as follows:

Occurrence in a rolling 12-month period	Sanction
First	Documented informal discussion
Second	Written warning, live for 6 months
Third	Final written warning, live for 12 months
Fourth	Referral for dismissal

An absence referral arising from a Bradford score of 400 or above (HC-PC-002 §2.6.2) enters this table at the informal stage, because a high Bradford score reflects frequency rather than fault.

Section 6.4: Gross Misconduct

Gross misconduct may result in summary dismissal without notice. It includes: theft or fraud; falsifying a medical certificate or claiming sick leave for a purpose other than genuine incapacity (HC-PC-002 §2.7); submitting an

expense claim for an expense not incurred, or inflating one (HC-PC-005 §5.8); serious breach of confidentiality; and violence or harassment.

An allegation of gross misconduct is always investigated before any decision, and the employee is always given the opportunity to respond.

Section 6.5: Remote Working Breaches

Persistent failure to attend the office on the agreed pattern, misrepresentation of remote working location, or accessing Company data over an unsecured network (HC-PC-004 §4.4.2) is dealt with under this policy. A first breach normally results in withdrawal of the remote arrangement rather than a formal sanction, unless data was placed at risk.

Section 6.6: Right of Appeal

Any disciplinary sanction may be appealed within **10 working days** under HC-PC-009 §9.2.

For queries about this policy, contact People & Culture at people@hcservices.ae or raise a query via the HCS Concierge.